

1947, June 28.

The following is a faithful transcription of the carbon copy of the typed original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

ST. FELIX CAPUCHIN FRIARY
Huntington, Indiana
June 28, 1947

Mr. Merrick O'Loughlin
Detroit, Michigan

Dear Friend:

God bless you and yours. I hope you are well, as evidently you are not too bad to write such an interesting letter as that which I have just read from your pen. And all notwithstanding your trying berievement of losing your dear, patient Wife Mercile.

I surely would like to have seen her and consoled her before it were too late. Rather I should say, to encourage her in her acts and dispositions of faith, hope, charity, patience, resignation, confidence in God etc. What a privilege; what a happiness to have been of assistance to anyone in their final struggle and to have whispered an encouraging prayer into the ear of the patient when naturally everything must seem dark and hopeless! From what you have written of her, however, with all her struggles and humiliations, etc, I think she must have learned quite a little of the one most important art of "dying well".

Incidently, I had an "atheist" in-law lose his eldest born, ten years ago on his way with his family to the diamond jubilee of his wife's parish - St. Joseph's in Prescott, Wis. That was where myself and a number of my brothers and sisters had been baptized, including one of my Rev. brothers.

I said "atheist" because he had never been taught much, if anything in childhood, about God and the science of religion and consequently had never joined any denomination. He was a good, clean-living man, however, and from the outstanding example of his wife - Kathleen O'Brien her maiden name - and the sweet prayers and peace pervading his home as a result; he had learned to admire the wonderful faith, so inspiring of hope and real supernatural charity, she practiced and fostered.